

Entrepreneurship and Startup Acceleration

BUS-005 · Week 1 of 12 · Business and Entrepreneurship

Study independently · keep a notebook · save your evidence



THIS WEEK'S OUTCOME

Validate a problem with customer evidence.

STUDY RHYTHM

6 hours

Short sessions work best: Read · Watch · Make · Reflect.

START HERE · IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

In plain language, this lesson helps you work on validate a problem with customer evidence.. Treat opportunity and context as a skill you can build in small steps: study one idea, compare it with a real Liberian or regional example, and save a short piece of evidence of what you understood.

01

READ

Find the main idea.

02

WATCH

Notice a method.

03

MAKE

Try it locally.

04

REFLECT

Check what changed.

Your learning path

READ FOR THE IDEA

Read for the main idea: Validate a problem with customer evidence.

WATCH FOR THE METHOD

Watch for one method or example connected to opportunity and context.

MAKE EVIDENCE

Apply the idea locally and save validated model and pitch deck.

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How could opportunity and context improve a real situation connected to Entrepreneurship and Startup Acceleration?

Write one sentence before you begin. Revisit it after you apply the activity.

Detailed lesson notes

CONCEPT NOTE

This original lecture note places “Validate a problem with customer evidence.” inside the wider work of Entrepreneurship and Startup Acceleration. The week is not only about remembering a definition. It is about understanding the choices behind the work: value, evidence, and responsible decisions. Begin with a small enterprise, service, or community opportunity, then use the linked academic source to compare your first idea with a more formal explanation.

A useful way to learn this topic is to move from a situation to a decision and then to evidence. First describe what is happening and who needs a better result. Next identify the information, people, tools, or constraints that shape the decision. Finally make a small, responsible attempt and explain what you would improve. This sequence keeps self-study practical and prevents a learner from copying a solution without understanding the reason for it.

01 • PURPOSE

Purpose: connect opportunity and context to the outcome “Validate a problem with customer evidence.”.

02 • METHOD

Method: state the problem, identify who is affected, test an assumption, and record what happened.

03 • EVIDENCE

Evidence: save a short record that another learner could understand and review.

INSTRUCTIONS • WORK IN ORDER

1. Read the guide and linked source for the main concept; write down two unfamiliar terms.
2. Describe a local or regional example without including private or identifying information.
3. Complete the weekly exercise using safe sample data, a fictional scenario, or your own non-sensitive work.
4. Review your result against the self-check questions and record one improvement for the next session.

WEEKLY EXERCISE

Exercise: Entrepreneurship and Startup Acceleration learners should state the problem, identify who is affected, test an assumption, and record what happened. Use the week’s focus as your test case and save validated model and pitch deck.

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ACADEMIC READING · SOURCE RECORD

New Enterprises: entrepreneurship foundations

Provider	MIT OpenCourseWare
Kind	University open course
Licence / access	MIT OpenCourseWare terms
Official URL	Open official source at ocw.mit.edu

Use it this week: Read selectively for this week's opportunity and context work.

UNIVERSITY OR PROFESSOR VIDEO · SOURCE RECORD

Lecture 1: What is Entrepreneurship?

Provider	MIT OpenCourseWare · Bill Aulet
Kind	University lecture or official educational video
Licence / access	Access terms apply; video remains the property of its provider and platform.
Official URL	Open official source at youtube.com

Use it this week: Watch with the Entrepreneurship and Startup Acceleration learning outcome in mind; take notes on an idea to test locally.

Turn study into skill

PRACTICE LABORATORY

Complete a guided opportunity and local context activity using a Liberian or regional case study.

Keep your work simple, local, and real. A basic note, recording, checklist, screenshot, calculation, or plan is valid practice.

EVIDENCE CHECKLIST

- ☐ I named the main idea.
- ☐ I noted one example.
- ☐ I tried one small action.
- ☐ I saved validated model and pitch deck.

SELF-CHECK · BEFORE YOU FINISH

1. What is the main idea in your own words?
2. Which decision or assumption most affects the result?
3. What evidence would show that your approach is useful and responsible?
4. What is one next action I can test or improve?

REFLECT AND CONNECT

In 3–5 sentences, explain how this week's concept could improve a real organisation, community service, workplace, or learner project. Identify one assumption, one risk, and one action you would test next.

Vocabulary + notebook

Use this final page as a learning checkpoint. Clear terms and brief notes make independent study easier to continue.

SMALL SELF-STUDY GLOSSARY

self-directed study (self-study) means you manage your own learning plan. **learning evidence (evidence)** is the proof you save. A **learning source (source)** is credited to its original provider.

Glossary reference list

evidence – learning evidence: A saved note, plan, calculation, recording, checklist, or other item that shows what you can do.

self-study – self-directed study: A learner plans, studies, practises, and checks understanding without waiting for a live class.

source – learning source: An external reading or video credited to its original provider.

MY NOTE BANK

The one idea I want to remember:

The example I will look for this week:

FINISH WELL

Choose a time for your next study session. Small regular sessions are more useful than waiting for a perfect long study day.

SHARE SAFELY

Discuss an idea with a trusted peer, mentor, or colleague. Keep your own notes and do not share sensitive personal or workplace data.

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